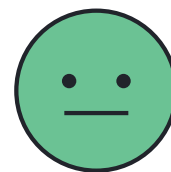
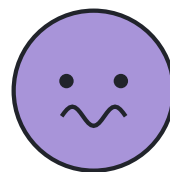
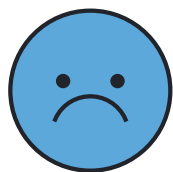




TEEN WELLBEING SEL SERIES



Bounce Back

Building Resilience & Coping Skills for Teens

Written by Daniel Tesfamariam

Ages 10-19 - Printable

Home - Classroom - Counseling - Calm Corners

Reproducible for one home or classroom



How to Use This Book

This workbook is made for ages 10 to 19 - a stage packed with change, pressure, and big emotions. It won't talk down to you. Instead, it gives you real tools, honest questions, and space to think for yourself.

There are no grades and no wrong answers. Work at your own pace, be honest in the writing spaces, and come back to the pages that help most. Skills grow with practice.

For Grown-Ups

- ☐ Give privacy - journaling is more honest when it isn't graded or read without permission.
- ☐ Offer to talk, but don't force it; being available matters more than pushing.
- ☐ Model the skills yourself - teens notice what adults actually do.
- ☐ If big feelings feel unmanageable, connect the teen with a counselor or trusted professional.

Tip: There are no wrong answers here. Every feeling is okay. What matters is what we choose to DO with big feelings.

How This Book Works



Each part mixes three things: short explanations of what's going on in your brain and body, self-checks to notice your own patterns, and tools plus reflection to help you respond in ways you feel good about.

Getting the most from it

- ☐ Be honest - this is for you, not for show.
- ☐ Try the tools more than once before deciding if they help.
- ☐ Use the trackers to spot patterns over a week or two.
- ☐ Revisit the plans and update them as you learn.

This activity book supports everyday social-emotional learning and self-reflection. It is not therapy or medical advice. If you are struggling with your safety or mental health, please talk to a trusted adult, a counselor, or a local helpline right away.

What's Inside



- 1 What Resilience Is
- 2 My Coping Style
- 3 Coping Toolkit
- 4 Growth Mindset
- 5 Real-Life Scenarios
- 6 Reflection & Plan



Part 1: What Resilience Is

Resilience is a skill, not a personality.



Bending Without Breaking

Resilience is the ability to cope with hard times and bounce back - not by never struggling, but by adapting and recovering. Resilient people still feel pain, fear, and doubt; they've just built skills to get through it.

The good news: resilience is learnable. Every hard thing you get through - with support and the right tools - builds it, like a muscle.

Resilience is built by

- ☐ Strong connections with people you trust.
- ☐ Coping skills you practice ahead of time.
- ☐ A belief that you can grow and things can improve.
- ☐ Taking care of your basics: sleep, food, movement.



My Resilience Check

Rate how true each is right now.

1 = Never 5 = Always

I can calm myself when I'm upset.

☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

I have people I can lean on.

☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

I believe hard times will pass.

☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

I learn from setbacks instead of only dwelling.

☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

I take care of my body's basics.

☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

I can ask for help when I need it.

☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

What my answers tell me



Part 2: My Coping Style

Some coping helps; some just numbs.



Helpful vs. Numbing Coping

When life gets hard, we all cope somehow. Helpful coping deals with the feeling or the problem (talking, moving, planning, resting). Numbing coping just avoids it (endless scrolling, isolating, lashing out) and often makes things worse later.

There's no shame in having some numbing habits - almost everyone does. The goal is to grow the helpful ones so you reach for them first.

Ask yourself

- ☐ Does this help me now AND later?
- ☐ Am I facing the feeling or just escaping it?
- ☐ Would I suggest this to a friend?



What I Do When Things Get Hard

When you feel stressed or overwhelmed, logging it helps you understand your triggers and what actually helps. Fill one row when a stressful moment happens.

- 1** Situation / trigger: _____
Body & feelings (0-10): _____
What I did: _____
Did it help?: _____
- 2** Situation / trigger: _____
Body & feelings (0-10): _____
What I did: _____
Did it help?: _____
- 3** Situation / trigger: _____
Body & feelings (0-10): _____
What I did: _____
Did it help?: _____
- 4** Situation / trigger: _____
Body & feelings (0-10): _____
What I did: _____
Did it help?: _____



Part 3: Coping Toolkit

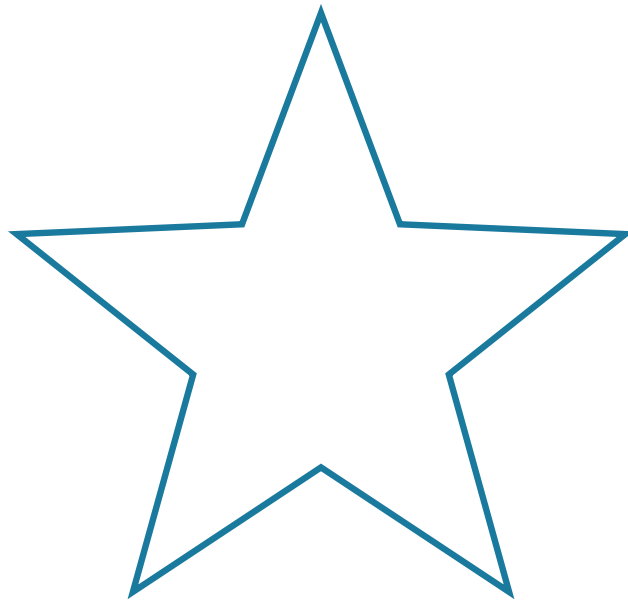
Build your kit before you need it.



Grounding Breath

Slow breathing tells our body it is safe. Trace the shape slowly with your finger while you breathe. Do it 3-5 times.

Star Breathing



1. Trace up a point as you breathe in.
2. Trace down as you breathe out.
3. Move slowly around all five points.
4. Finish with one long, calm breath.

My Resilience Toolkit



Tick what you'll try; star what works.

Fast resets (under 2 minutes)

- ☐ Slow breathing: in for 4, out for 6, a few rounds.
- ☐ Cold water on your face or hands.
- ☐ Name 5 things you see, 4 you hear, 3 you can touch.
- ☐ Unclench your jaw, drop your shoulders, shake out your hands.

Move & release

- ☐ Walk, stretch, or do a few push-ups or jumping jacks.
- ☐ Put on a song and move to it.
- ☐ Squeeze and release your muscles from head to toe.

Connect & express

- ☐ Text or talk to someone you trust.
- ☐ Write or draw what you're feeling - no filter.
- ☐ Do something kind for someone else.

Longer-term care

- ☐ Keep a steady sleep routine.
- ☐ Limit doom-scrolling before bed.
- ☐ Spend time on something that gives you meaning.



Part 4: Growth Mindset

'I can't do it' vs. 'I can't do it yet.'



The Power of 'Yet'

A growth mindset is believing your abilities can develop with effort and practice. A fixed mindset says 'I'm just bad at this.' A growth mindset adds one word: 'I'm not good at this YET.'

Setbacks stop being proof you're a failure and start being information about what to try next. That shift builds serious resilience.

Growth-mindset self-talk

- ☐ 'Mistakes help me learn.'
- ☐ 'This is hard, which means I'm growing.'
- ☐ 'I'll try a different strategy.'



Turning Setbacks Into Lessons

Our thoughts shape our feelings. Sometimes an automatic thought is unhelpful or untrue. You can CATCH the thought, CHECK if it's fair and true, and CHANGE it into a more balanced one. This is a skill - it gets easier with practice.

1. The situation (just the facts):

2. The automatic thought that popped up:

3. The feeling it gave me (and how strong, 0-10):

4. Check it: Is it 100% true? What's the evidence? Am I mind-reading or catastrophizing?

5. A more balanced, fair thought:

6. How I feel now:



Part 5: Real-Life Scenarios

Bounce back in real life.



Setback Situations (1)

Read each situation. There are many good choices! Think it through, then write or draw what you could do to stay calm and kind.

1 You worked hard but still failed a test.

What could you do?

2 You didn't make the team or get the role.

What could you do?

3 A friendship or relationship ended.

What could you do?



Setback Situations (2)

Read each situation. There are many good choices! Think it through, then write or draw what you could do to stay calm and kind.

1 You're going through a big change (new school, move, family change).

What could you do?

2 You made a public mistake and feel embarrassed.

What could you do?

3 Everything feels like too much at once.

What could you do?



My Bounce-Back Plan

Your plan for getting through hard times.

My support people (and how to reach them):

My top coping tools:

A growth-mindset phrase I'll use:

One way I'll care for my basics:

My Personal Wellbeing Plan



Pull it all together. This is your go-to plan when things get hard.

My early warning signs that a feeling is getting big:

My top 3 tools that actually work for me:

People I can reach out to (and how):

Kind, true things I can tell myself:

One habit that helps me feel steady:



When You Need More Help

Some feelings are too big to handle alone - and that's not weakness, it's human. Reaching out is a strong, smart move.

Reach out if...

- ☐ A feeling won't ease up for days, or keeps getting worse.
- ☐ You're avoiding things you used to enjoy.
- ☐ You have thoughts of hurting yourself or others.
- ☐ You just need someone to talk to - that's reason enough.

Who I can reach out to

If you ever feel unsafe or think about hurting yourself, tell a trusted adult now or contact a local emergency number or crisis/helpline in your country right away. You deserve support.



What Matters to Me

Knowing what matters to you makes decisions and hard days easier. When you act in line with your values, stress often makes more sense and feels more manageable.

Three values that matter most to me

One goal that fits those values

One small step I can take this week



Checking In With Myself

What's one thing I'm handling better than I used to?

What still feels hard, and what might help?



Saying It: Boundary Scripts

A boundary is a limit that protects your wellbeing. Boundaries can be kind AND firm. Practice wording so it's ready when you need it.

Saying no without over-explaining: "No thanks, that doesn't work for me." My version:

Asking for space: "I need some time to myself right now." My version:

Naming a limit online: "Please don't share that." My version:

Asking for what I need: "It would help me if..." My version:



A Letter to Future Me

Write a short letter to yourself six months from now.

What do you hope is different? What do you want to remember?



Good Things Worth Noticing

Noticing good things helps calm our minds and lift our mood. It doesn't erase hard feelings, but it reminds us that good things are here too.

Three good things about today

Someone I'm thankful for - and why

Draw something that makes you smile:

A large, empty rectangular box with rounded corners and a thin grey border, intended for a drawing.

My Notes & Reflections



Lined area for notes and reflections, consisting of 20 horizontal lines.



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